Kuol Akech Riak Kuol

Full-Stack Developer & Digital Communications Specialist

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SUMMARY

Full-Stack Developer and Digital Communications Specialist who ships full products, not just code | designing databases and backends, building interfaces, and pairing them with the brand systems and writing that make people trust what they're using. Proven across six African countries: platforms that manage real land and identity data, communications strategy for a multi-country organization, and mentorship programs that turn frameworks into results. Currently completing a Software Engineering degree at the African Leadership University while actively delivering for clients and communities across the continent.

EDUCATIONAL BACKGROUND

African Leadership University | Kigali, Rwanda September 2025 – Present
Undergraduate Student, Software Engineering

PROFESSIONAL WORK EXPERIENCE

Peacepedia – Continental April 2026 – August 2026
Communications Officer (Volunteer) | Juba, South Sudan · Kigali, Rwanda · Nairobi, Kenya · Bujumbura, Burundi · Adjumani, Uganda · Banjul, Gambia

- Adapted peacebuilding messages for audiences, producing posts, articles, and newsletters.
- Edited contributor content for clarity and accuracy, and kept a consistent voice and visual identity across country channels with a team of 3 contributors.
- Tracked reach and engagement and shared monthly performance summaries with the team.

Spark Foundation – South Sudan November 2025 – May 2026
Mentor (Volunteer) | Juba Airport Road, Juba, South Sudan

- Mentored 3 younger students through a structured leadership programme, holding regular one-on-one sessions over seven months.
- Turned the programme's curriculum into practical, personal guidance, linking each leadership topic to what students were dealing with that week.
- Led follow-up conversations to track each student's progress and adjust guidance, building trust and steady engagement over time.

Wong Amit Diary – South Sudan November 2025 – March 2026
Social Media Manager (Volunteer) | Sherikat, Juba, South Sudan

- Planned a monthly content calendar for Facebook and LinkedIn, raising average engagement by 25% in 5 months by publishing fewer, higher-quality posts.
- Monitored channel analytics and prepared weekly performance summaries to guide content decisions.
- Selected and captioned photographs, confirming permission from people featured before publishing.

KEY PROJECTS

TerraTrust Foundation | Full-stack land-documentation platform
Designed and built the whole system myself: a Django and PostgreSQL/PostGIS backend with identity and location data kept separate by design, serving a React dashboard, a public map, and an offline-capable React Native field app.

DreamReach | Scholarship & internship discovery platform
Built a search tool that pulls live listings via the Remotive API alongside a hand-curated scholarship list, replacing a search that used to be scattered across a dozen sites.

EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Creative Writing & Poetry
Write poetry rooted in personal history, including the experience of leaving South Sudan at nine during the war, and have presented published creative work to colleagues and peers.

SKILLS

Backend
Django · PostgreSQL & PostGIS · SQL · API Design & Integration · Database & Systems Architecture

Frontend
React & React Native · JavaScript, HTML & CSS · Responsive & Accessible Design

Design & Writing
Graphic Design & Brand Identity · Investor & Pitch Decks · Personal Essays

Communications & Leadership
Communications Strategy · Social Media Management · Mentorship & Leadership

LANGUAGES

Dinka — NATIVE **English** — EXPERT **Arabic** — GOOD